

Date: 12 June 2026

TO: SHEIKH HAMDAN BIN RASHED AL MAKTOUM FOR MEDICAL AND EDUCATIONAL SCIENCES

Subject: Nomination Letter - The Hamdan Award for Distinguished Personalities - UAE Awards Category

Your Excellencies, Members of the Award Committee,

In my capacity as Group Chief Medical Officer of Burjeel Holdings, I am honored to nominate Professor Humaid Obaid Alshamsi, CEO of Burjeel Cancer Institute, for the Hamdan Award for Distinguished Personalities in the UAE Awards category. Since joining Burjeel Holdings in September 2020 as the Director of Oncology Services, Professor Alshamsi has played a transformative role in advancing cancer care across the United Arab Emirates. With more than 20 years of experience as a consultant oncologist, he has made outstanding contributions to clinical excellence, education, research, and national cancer care development.

Under his leadership, the UAE's largest comprehensive cancer network was established, with centers in Abu Dhabi, Sharjah, Al Ain, and Al Ruwais. This achievement has significantly improved access to cancer care by bringing specialized services closer to patients' homes, reducing travel burdens and ensuring timely, high-quality treatment for patients and families across the country. He is also known for his strong humanitarian commitment, providing free consultations to uninsured cancer patients from diverse backgrounds and working closely with charitable organizations to ensure that financial and social support reaches patients regardless of where they receive treatment.

Professor Alshamsi achieved a major milestone by securing the first and only ESMO accreditation for a UAE cancer center ([ESMO accreditation announcement](#)). He also established the nation's foremost comprehensive bone marrow transplant unit, successfully completing 160 transplants, with over 50 provided free of charge to international patients from 20 different nationalities. This initiative significantly improved access to life-saving bone marrow transplantation across the UAE and the region. Notably, this was accomplished during the peak of the COVID-19 pandemic, when international travel was restricted, making it a critical and life-saving intervention for many patients ([media coverage](#)).

Professor Alshamsi has played a pivotal role in shaping national oncology policy and regulatory frameworks in the UAE. In collaboration with the Dubai Health Authority (DHA), he contributed to the development and national rollout of advanced oncology care standards in 2024, strengthening the quality, standardization, and delivery of cancer services across Dubai ([WAM announcement](#)).

Through the Emirates Oncology Society and in partnership with the Ministry of Health and Prevention (MOHAP), he also contributed to the development of the UAE's National Guideline for Lung Cancer Screening and Diagnosis (in November 2025), establishing a unified, evidence-based framework for early detection and risk stratification nationwide ([MOHAP announcement](#)).

Furthermore, he contributed to the establishment of the National Multidisciplinary Committee for Cancer Case Assessment in 2025 under Ministerial Decree No. (20), formalizing multidisciplinary decision-making and significantly strengthening coordinated cancer care at the national level ([official announcement](#)).

In research, Professor Alshamsi is a prolific contributor with over 200 peer-reviewed publications ([publication record](#)). He is also the editor of the most widely downloaded medical book in the MENA region; available free of charge and downloaded more than 650,000 times ([link](#)). His second book, "Cancer Care in the United Arab Emirates" ([link](#)), has been downloaded over 320,000 times. His recent book, "Healthcare in the United Arab Emirates" ([link](#)), has surpassed 315,000 downloads, further advancing his mission to make medical knowledge widely accessible. All of his books are freely available in electronic PDF format, reflecting his strong commitment to open-access education, scientific dissemination, and knowledge sharing.

As an educator, he serves as Adjunct Professor at the University of Sharjah and Full Professor at RAK Medical and Health Sciences University. He has developed a comprehensive oncology and palliative care curriculum ([link](#)), teaches extensively at both institutions, and serves as Chairman of the Hematology and Oncology Fellowship Committee at the National Institute for Health Specialties. He also established the first Hematology and Oncology Fellowship Program in the UAE's history ([link](#)).

In addition, he holds prestigious international academic appointments as a Visiting Professor at Harvard Medical School, Harvard University, Boston, USA, and a Visiting Scientist at Dana-Farber Cancer Institute, Harvard University, Boston, USA, further reflecting his global academic leadership and contributions to oncology education and research.

His leadership extends to regional and international roles, including Chair of the NCCN MENA Region Colorectal Working Group and Chair of the Gulf Cancer Society. As President of the Emirates Oncology Society (<https://eos-uae.com/>), he has transformed oncology education in the UAE through numerous conferences and workshops, all of which are provided free of charge to healthcare providers across the UAE and the GCC.

He was also appointed by the UAE Ministry of Health and Prevention (MOHAP) to the national committee responsible for the development and approval of national cancer screening guidelines for the UAE ([published guideline](#)). In addition, he serves as an advisor to Dubai Health on oncology services ([media coverage](#)).

Professor Alshamsi is also a leading advocate for cancer awareness, reaching a global audience through his substantial social media presence. He is one of the most followed oncologists worldwide, with over 530,000 followers on Instagram ([@dr.humaidalshamsi](#)) and 300,000 followers on TikTok, where he shares educational content focused on early cancer detection and prevention. His efforts have significantly improved public awareness and increased acceptance of cancer screening within UAE society.

He was awarded the Sheikha Fatima bint Mubarak Program for Excellence and Community Intelligence Award (7th Cycle – February 2025) in the Distinguished Personality category. The award was presented by His Highness Sheikh Mohamed bin Zayed Al Nahyan, President of the UAE. It recognizes his outstanding contributions to community leadership and social impact. These contributions are reflected through his roles as President of the Emirates Oncology Society and Executive Director & CEO of Burjeel Cancer Institute.

In addition, his achievements have been recognized through several prestigious awards, including the Nafis Award for Healthcare Leaders (2024), the Feigenbaum Leadership Excellence Award (2022) from Hamdan Bin Mohammed Smart University in Dubai, and the Sharjah Award for Voluntary Work (2022).

Professor Alshamsi’s unwavering commitment to advancing cancer care, research, education, and health system development, along with his impactful national and international contributions, make him an exemplary candidate for this prestigious award. His leadership has not only transformed oncology services in the UAE but has also set new benchmarks for patient-centered, accessible, and high-quality cancer care across the region.

Respectfully submitted,




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